Specification of the controlled designation of origin "MOSELLE"

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CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin "Moselle", initially recognised as a designation of origin "vin délimité de qualité supérieure" by the order of 9 August 1951.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

The name of the controlled designation of origin may be supplemented by one of the following customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the grape varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned and according to the production conditions set out in the present specification:

DENOMINATION (White wines)	GRAPE VARIETIES
Pinot Gris	pinot gris G
Müller-Thurgau	müller-thurgau B

III. – Colour and types of product

The controlled designation of origin "Moselle" is reserved for still white, red and rosé wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1. Geographical area

All stages of production (harvesting of the grapes, vinification and elaboration) take place within the geographical area approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the session of the competent national committee of 16 November 2010. The perimeter of this area, on the date of approval of the present specification by the competent national committee, encompasses the territory of the following communes on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2017:

- In the Meurthe-et-Moselle department: Arnaville.

- In the Moselle department: Ancy-Dornot, Ars-sur-Moselle, Contz-les-Bains, Fey, Jussy, Haute-Kontz, Lessy, Lorry-Mardigny, Marange-Silvange, Marieulles, Novéant-sur-Moselle, Plappeville, Rozérieulles, Scy-Chazelles, Sierck-les-Bains, Vaux, Vic-sur-Seille.

The cartographic documents representing the geographical area may be consulted on the website of the National Institute of Origin and Quality.

2. Delimited parcel area

The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the session of the competent national committee of 20 June 2018.

The cartographic documents representing the delimited parcel area may be consulted on the website of the National Institute of Origin and Quality.

3. Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification and the elaboration of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes of the Moselle department: Ay-sur-Moselle, Berg-sur-Moselle, Lorry-lès-Metz, Malling, Marsal, Montigny-lès-Metz, Moulin-lès-Metz.

V. – Grape varieties

1. Grape varieties

a) The white wines come from the following varieties:

- main varieties: auxerrois B, müller-thurgau B, pinot gris G;

- accessory varieties: gewurztraminer Rs, pinot blanc B, riesling B.

b) The rosé wines come from the following varieties:

- main variety: pinot noir N;

- accessory variety: gamay N.

c) The red wines come from the single variety pinot noir N.

2. Proportion rules on the holding

a) White wines:

- The proportion of the main varieties is greater than or equal to 70 % of the planting;

- The proportion of the gewurztraminer Rs variety is less than or equal to 10 %.

b) Rosé wines:

The proportion of the main variety is greater than or equal to 70 % of the planting.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1. Training methods

a) Planting density

The vines have a minimum planting density of 5,000 plants per hectare. The spacing between rows may not exceed 2 metres. The spacing between plants within the same row is between 0.80 metre and 1.30 metres.

b) Pruning rules

The vines are pruned either by short pruning (double or unilateral Royat cordon) or by single Guyot or double Guyot pruning, with a maximum of:

- 17 free eyes per plant and 9 free eyes per square metre of ground surface for white and rosé wines;

- 12 free eyes per plant and 6 free eyes per square metre of ground surface for red wines.

The number of fruit-bearing shoots of the year per plant, after flowering (Lorenz phenological stage 23), is less than or equal to 10 for black varieties and 12 for white, grey and pink varieties.

c) Trellising and foliage height rules

The height of trellised foliage must be at least equal to 0.65 times the spacing between rows. This height is measured between the first attachment wire and the upper trimming limit, set at least 0.20 metre above the upper trellising wire.

d) Average maximum load per parcel

The average maximum load per parcel is set at:

- 10,500 kilograms per hectare for white wines;

- 9,500 kilograms per hectare for red and rosé wines.

e) Thresholds of missing vines

The percentage of dead or missing vine plants referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 20 %.

f) Cultivation condition of the vine

The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2. Other cultivation practices

In order to preserve the characteristics of the physical and biological environment, which constitutes a fundamental element of the terroir, permanent grass cover of the edges of the parcels (headlands and unplanted or uncultivated spaces between parcels) is compulsory. This obligation does not apply in the case of restoration of the headlands, in particular following erosion or exceptional climatic phenomena.

Chemical weeding of the headlands is prohibited.

Total chemical weeding of the parcels is prohibited.

Plastic mulching is prohibited.

3. Irrigation

Irrigation is prohibited.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1. Harvest

a) The wines come from grapes harvested at good ripeness.

The date of the start of the harvest is set in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-6 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

b) Particular harvesting provisions

The wines come from grapes harvested by hand.

c) Particular provisions for transport of the harvest

Rinsing of the harvest containers after each emptying is compulsory.

2. Ripeness of the grapes

The sugar content of the grapes and the natural alcoholic strengths by volume of the wines meet the following characteristics:

WINES	MINIMUM SUGAR CONTENT OF THE GRAPES (grams per litre of must)	MINIMUM NATURAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME
White wines supplemented by the customary denomination Müller-Thurgau	153	9 %
Müller-Thurgau wines intended for blending into white wines	153	-
White wines supplemented by the customary denomination Pinot Gris	170	10 %
Other white and rosé wines	170	10 %
Red wines	180	10.5 %

VIII. – Yields – Entry into production

1. Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at:

- 68 hectolitres per hectare for white wines;

- 60 hectolitres per hectare for rosé wines;

- 55 hectolitres per hectare for red wines.

2. Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at:

- 73 hectolitres per hectare for white wines;

- 66 hectolitres per hectare for rosé wines;

- 60 hectolitres per hectare for red wines.

3. Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may only be granted to wines coming from:

- parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 1st year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the planting of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1. General provisions

The wines are vinified according to local, fair and constant usages.

a) Reception and pressing

Daily washing of the press is compulsory.

b) Blending of varieties

- White wines come from a single main variety or from a blend of grapes or wines.

- In the case of blended white wines:

    o The proportion of each of the varieties auxerrois B and pinot gris G is between 30 % and 60 % of the blend.

    o The proportion of the gewurztraminer Rs variety is less than or equal to 10 % of the blend.

- Rosé wines come from the main variety alone or from a blend of grapes or wines in which the proportion of the main variety is greater than or equal to 70 %.

c) Malolactic fermentation

Red wines, ready to be sold in bulk and at the packaging stage, have a malic acid content less than or equal to 0.4 gram per litre.

d) Analytical standards

Lots of white wines ready to be sold in bulk or at the packaging stage have, after fermentation, a fermentable sugar content (glucose + fructose) that does not exceed by more than 2 grams per litre the total acidity expressed in grams of tartaric acid per litre, within a maximum limit of 8 grams per litre.

Lots of rosé wines ready to be sold in bulk or at the packaging stage have, after fermentation, a fermentable sugar content (glucose + fructose) less than or equal to 4 grams per litre.

Lots of red wines ready to be sold in bulk or at the packaging stage have, after fermentation, a fermentable sugar content (glucose + fructose) less than or equal to 3 grams per litre.

e) Oenological practices and physical treatments

- For the elaboration of rosé wines, the use of oenological charcoal, alone or mixed in preparations, is prohibited;

- Any thermal treatment of the harvest involving a temperature higher than 40 °C is prohibited if it is followed by an immediate separation of the liquid and solid phases;

- The use of pieces of wood is prohibited;

- After enrichment, red wines do not exceed a total alcoholic strength by volume of 12.5 %;

- After enrichment, rosé and white wines do not exceed a total alcoholic strength by volume of 12 %, with the exception of white wines made exclusively from the müller-thurgau B variety, whose total alcoholic strength by volume does not exceed 11 %.

f) Prohibited equipment

The use of continuous presses and of centrifugal pumps for the transfer of the harvest is prohibited.

g) Vat capacity

Every operator has a vinification vat capacity at least equal to 1.3 times the volume vinified during the previous harvest, for an equal area.

h) Upkeep of the cellar and equipment

The cellar (floor and walls) and the vinification equipment are in a good general state of upkeep.

2. Provisions by type of product

Rosé wines are elaborated:

- after compulsory destemming of the grapes;

- by maceration of the destemmed harvest for a period of between 24 hours and 48 hours.

3. Provisions relating to packaging

For every packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body:

- the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code;

- an analysis carried out before or after packaging.

The analysis reports are kept for a period of 6 months from the date of packaging.

4. Provisions relating to storage

The operator provides evidence of an appropriate place for the storage of packaged wines.

5. Provisions relating to the circulation of products and placing on the market for the consumer

a) Date of placing on the market for the consumer

The wines are placed on the market for the consumer in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-17 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1. Information on the geographical area

a) Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The geographical area is situated in the north-east of French territory, where it occupies a characteristic cuesta relief whose adjacent valleys present east- and south-facing slopes. It extends over 18 communes of the Moselle and Meurthe-et-Moselle departments.

The scarp crests are made up of hard layers of limestone, sandstone or dolomite. The slopes of the hillsides are marly and softer, cleared by erosion and then covered with colluvial deposits coming from the overlying scarp crests. In places, discontinuous patches of old Moselle alluvium are found on the lower part of the slopes.

The soils are predominantly clay-limestone and contain relatively abundant coarse elements.

The parcels, precisely delimited for the harvesting of the grapes, form part of a landscape characterised by a hillside vineyard lying on the cuestas of the eastern Paris Basin:

- the Côte de Moselle and its fore-scarp, as well as the broader slopes of the associated re-entrant valleys, characterising the Pays Messin;

- the Infraliassic Côte, which stretches from north to south in two separate units, the Sierck sector, near the Luxembourg border, and Vic-sur-Seille, south of Château-Salins;

- the Côte de Lorraine, which represents only a small part of the Sierck sector (relief of the Stromberg).

The Moselle vineyard is a northern vineyard, subject to a temperate continental climatic influence responsible for sometimes destructive frosts and for favourable sunshine in summer. This influence is however attenuated by the opening of the geographical area to westerly oceanic air flows, rainy but less cold, and is above all strongly influenced by the local orographic features, namely the cuestas. The

cuestas, whose crests are mostly wooded, form a protective screen favouring relatively high sunshine (1,600 hours per year in Metz), fairly low rainfall (annual precipitation of the order of 1,000 to 1,200 millimetres on the Lorraine plateau, compared with about 800 millimetres on the wine-growing slopes) and good late-season conditions.

b) Description of the human factors contributing to the link

The history of the Moselle wines goes back to Roman times, the City of Trier having played a driving role in the expansion of the vine along the main rivers in France, Germany and Luxembourg as well as in the Metz region.

Already in the Middle Ages, the three current wine-growing cores of French Moselle, the Val de Metz, the Val de Seille and the Val de Sierck, enjoyed a fine reputation thanks to the clergy (abbeys of Sainte-Glossinde, Gorze, Rettel), who established the finest vineyards there. The Bishop of Metz in particular played a key role at Vic-sur-Seille, where in 1231 he planted a vineyard similar to that of the Val de Metz.

During the Early Modern period, the bourgeoisie gradually took over the Metz vineyard and made it prosper by extending it onto the Côte de Moselle. Until the Revolution, these fine, “clairet” wines, made from the pinot and auxerrois varieties and confined to the Jurassic limestone slopes, were among the most highly appreciated.

The phylloxera crisis and the annexation of Moselle by the German Empire hit the Moselle vineyard very hard. Paradoxically, however, its near-destruction in the 19th century and at the beginning of the 20th century then enabled it to assert a real originality and to set itself apart from its German and Luxembourg neighbours by developing a diversified range of varieties: pinot noir N, pinot gris G, auxerrois B, müller-thurgau B, pinot blanc B, riesling B, gewurztraminer Rs and gamay N.

The Moselle vineyard favours training the foliage on high trellises, as well as wide spacing between plants.

The harvest is manual, and the grapes are transported with care to the vinification facilities.

The “Vins de Moselle” were recognised as a designation of origin “vin délimité de qualité supérieure” by the order of 9 August 1951, then under the name “Moselle” by the order of 13 April 1995.

Initially managed by 2 syndicates created in 1949, Moselle viticulture united around the Syndicat des Viticulteurs de Moselle from 1987. Moselle producers sell their production mainly through direct sales to private customers, restaurateurs or wine merchants.

Accession to controlled designation of origin status in 2010 reflects the strong commitment of the producers to a quality production recognised for its originality.

2. Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

The still wines come as white, red and rosé wines. They are dry and characterised by their freshness.

The white wines have a colour ranging from pale gold to yellow gold, and straw yellow for more mature wines. They are light and delicate and frequently show floral notes.

The red wines, made exclusively from the pinot noir N variety, have a colour ranging from ruby red to garnet red. They are finely tannic, with good length on the palate and red-fruit aromas.

The rosé wines have a slightly salmon-tinged pink colour and a fruity, fresh nose, harmoniously combining red fruit and floral notes on the palate.

3. Causal interactions

In the climatic and geo-pedological context of Moselle, the expected harvest objectives require favouring situations conducive to ripeness: well-exposed, well-aired parcels whose soils dry out quickly in spring. Thus, the wide opening of the landscape of the three cuestas onto the plain and the valleys guarantees the vineyards sufficient light for the ripening of the berries. This open landscape moreover prevents the stagnation of cold air and so reduces the risk of frost. In addition, the cuestas act as a protective screen against oceanic influences, a role amplified by a slight föhn effect, especially in autumn.

The slope of the wine-growing hillsides ensures optimal natural drainage, also guaranteed by the often abundant coarse elements present in the soils, which allow natural water regulation of the vine. The marly subsoil provides the water reserve, and the stoniness of the soils ensures the drying-out and infiltration of excess water during wet periods.

The wine-growers have adapted the production conditions, such as low density and high trellising of the foliage, to the climatic situation of Moselle, in order to guarantee satisfactory ripeness of the grapes and an optimal sanitary condition of the vines and berries. The choice of early-ripening varieties excludes low-lying, poorly oriented or poorly aired situations and, more generally, all frost-prone situations. Topographic situations favouring the circulation of air masses are preferred, hence the establishment of the vineyard on the slopes of the cuestas.

The diversity of varieties, worked by the producer both alone and blended, offers a complex range reflecting the richness of the Moselle vineyard.

The white wines best reflect the diversity of the varieties while highlighting the typicity of the controlled designation of origin “Moselle”, with a majority of wines vinified as single-variety pinot gris G, auxerrois B or müller-thurgau B. The majority and combined presence in the blended wines of the auxerrois B variety, a variety selected in Moselle, and of pinot gris G, widely planted in Moselle, reinforces the typicity of these wines. The elaboration of rosé wines is carried out after a short maceration of a harvest that must be destemmed. The aromatic palette of the red wines, made from the single variety pinot noir N, reflects the preferred soil of this variety, namely clay-limestone soils.

The existence of the Moselle vineyard goes back to the beginning of our era and, from Antiquity, its reputation was recognised, as attested by the poem of AUSONIUS (309–393), who speaks of the Moselle as a “river rich in slopes perfumed by Bacchus”. Later, numerous 19th-century authors attested to the renown of the Moselle wines. One may cite, for example, André JULLIEN in 1822, who wrote that “the vineyards of Scy, Jussy, Ars… harvest, on the south-facing slopes of the left bank of the Moselle, the most esteemed wines”. Finally, according to Jules GUYOT in 1863, “the Moselle is a true country of light, delicate, wholesome and everyday wine: thus the first founders of its vineyards planted the finest varieties there”.

Finally, the location of the Moselle wines within a region bordering three European countries plays an important role in the development of their renown.

XI. – Transitional measures

1. Delimited parcel area

On a transitional basis, the planted parcels or parts of parcels excluded from the delimited parcel area, identified by their cadastral reference and their area, the list of which was approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the session of the competent national committee of 20 June 2018, and provided that they meet the other conditions set out in the present specification, continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the designation “Moselle” until they are grubbed up and at the latest until the 2033 harvest inclusive.

2. Training methods

a) Vine parcels trained according to the so-called “lyre” system on 14 November 2011 benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until they are grubbed up and at the latest until the 2055 harvest inclusive.

For these parcels, the volume that may benefit from the right to the controlled designation of origin is established on the basis of the yield authorised for the controlled designation of origin for the harvest concerned, multiplied by a coefficient equal to the ratio between the planting density of the parcel concerned and the minimum planting density defined in 1° of VI of Chapter I of the present specification.

b) Vine parcels in place on 14 November 2011 with a planting density of between 4,500 and 5,000 plants per hectare or a spacing between rows greater than 2 metres benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until the 2030 harvest inclusive, provided that they have a trellised foliage height greater than or equal to 1.30 metres.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1. General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin “Moselle” is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

2. Particular provisions

a) The use of two or more customary denominations on the same label is prohibited.

b) The indication of a customary denomination is entered on the labels in characters whose dimensions, both in height and in width, are less than two-thirds of those of the characters of the name of the controlled designation of origin.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Prior declaration of parcel assignment

Every operator declares to the defence and management body the list of parcels assigned to the production of the controlled designation of origin before 15 March of the year of harvest.

This declaration is renewable by tacit renewal, unless changes are notified by the operator before 15 March preceding each harvest.

This declaration specifies:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identity of the operator receiving the grapes, where applicable;

- for each parcel: the cadastral reference, the area, the grape variety.

2. Declaration of renunciation to produce

Every operator declares to the defence and management body, before 15 August preceding the harvest, the parcels for which they renounce producing the controlled designation of origin.

The defence and management body transmits this declaration to the approved control body as soon as possible.

3. Claim declaration

The claim declaration is lodged with the defence and management body at least 15 days before the first exit of products from the vinification cellar and at the latest on 14 December of the year of harvest.

It indicates:

- the designation claimed;

- the volume of the wine;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the name and address of the applicant;

- the place of storage of the wine.

It is accompanied by a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for buyers of grapes and musts.

4. Prior transaction declaration

Every operator wishing to sell a wine of the controlled designation of origin in bulk declares the transaction for the lot concerned to the approved control body and to the defence and management body between the day the transaction is contracted and at the latest fifteen days before collection. The lot is defined as a homogeneous whole coming from one or more containers.

5. Prior packaging declaration

Every operator wishing to package a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin sends an extract of their packaging register to the approved control body each quarter and at the latest on the 10th of the first month of the following quarter.

6. Declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

Every operator wishing to dispatch outside the national territory a non-packaged wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin declares it to the approved control body at least fifteen working days before the dispatch.

7. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin declares it to the defence and management body and to the approved control body within a maximum period of 15 days after this downgrading.

II. – Keeping of registers

1. Vines under transitional provisions

a) Every operator working vines in place trained according to the so-called “lyre” system on the date of approval of the present specification keeps up to date a register indicating, for the parcels concerned:

- the cadastral reference;

- the area;

- the year of planting.

b) Every operator working vines in place on the date of approval of the present specification that do not comply with the provisions relating to the minimum planting density set out in the present specification keeps up to date a register indicating, for the parcels concerned:

- the cadastral reference;

- the area;

- the year of planting;

- the planting density;

- the spacings within the row and between rows.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area	Documentary check and check in the field
A2 – Claimable production potential (grape varieties and proportion rules, planting density and trellising, monitoring of transitional measures)	Documentary check and check in the field
A3 – Processing, ageing, packaging and storage facilities	
Place of vinification	Documentary check and on-site check
Traceability of packaging	Documentary check and on-site check
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard	
Pruning	Check in the field
Average maximum load per parcel	Check in the field
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes	
Manual harvesting	Check in the field
Ripeness of the grapes	Documentary check
B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage	
Blending in the wines	Documentary check and on-site check
Stock accounts, traceability	Documentary check
B4 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration	
Authorised yield	Documentary check
Claim declaration	Documentary check and on-site check; check of the release of products into circulation
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
At collection, for non-packaged wines	Analytical and organoleptic examination
Packaged wines	Analytical and organoleptic examination

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
Non-packaged wines intended for dispatch outside the national territory	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all lots

II. – References concerning the control structure

Institut national de l'origine et de la qualité (INAO)

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Compliance with the present specification is checked on the basis of an approved control plan, by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence that has received delegation from the INAO.